

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 4

Chapter 18: The State, the Government, and You

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	18 — The State, the Government, and You
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic traps: treating the government (one changing part) as the whole enduring state; counting an organ (legislature/executive/judiciary) or a role (protector/provider/regulator) or a tier (union/state/local) among the four PARTS of a state; calling the police/army or the bureaucracy 'the government'; assuming every democracy is a republic (the UK keeps a hereditary monarch); assuming a majority may do anything (rights and the rule of law shield minorities); swapping who-makes vs who-enforces vs who-interprets; mistaking decentralisation for concentrating power. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. An island community has a settled population, fixed borders, and a recognised right to make and enforce its own laws with no outside power overruling it, yet it has held no election and no team currently runs day-to-day affairs. Which one of the four parts of a state is it MOST clearly missing right now?

- (A) Population
- (B) Territory
- (C) Government
- (D) Sovereignty

2. A teacher lists six items and says 'three of these are PARTS of a state and three are not.' The six are: population, the judiciary, territory, the provider role, sovereignty, and the union tier. Which three are the genuine parts of a state?

- (A) The judiciary, the provider role and the union tier
- (B) Population, territory and sovereignty
- (C) Population, the judiciary and the provider role
- (D) Territory, sovereignty and the union tier

3. Using the chapter's school analogy, the school stands for the state and the teachers for the government. A student then says, 'So the school building IS the school.' Why does the analogy reject this reading?

- (A) The building is indeed the whole school, just as the buildings where ministers sit are the whole state
- (B) The teachers, not the school, are the lasting institution, so the building belongs to the government
- (C) The school ceases to exist whenever its teachers leave, just as the state ends when a government falls
- (D) The state is the political organisation of a people on a territory with sovereignty, not the physical building - just as the 'school' that endures is the institution, not its bricks

4. Country X loses a war and is absorbed: its land is annexed and its people now live under a neighbour's laws with no power to make their own. Of the four parts a state needs, which is the LAST one whose loss actually ends X's existence as a state?

- (A) A national flag, which every state must legally possess
- (B) Sovereignty - the power to make and enforce its own laws free of outside control
- (C) An independent judiciary, which is one of the four parts of a state
- (D) A standing army, without which no state can exist

5. Three statements are offered about the relationship between the state and its four parts. Which ONE is correct?

- (A) The government is the whole, and the state is one of its four parts
- (B) The territory is the whole, and population, government and sovereignty are inside the territory
- (C) Sovereignty is the whole, and the state is one expression of sovereignty
- (D) The state is the whole made of four parts, and the government is just one of those parts

6. A newly recognised country immediately elects a parliament and forms a cabinet, draws agreed borders, and has citizens living within them - but a powerful neighbour reserves the right to veto any law it passes. Compared with a fully sovereign state, what is true?

- (A) It is a complete state, since electing a parliament automatically confers sovereignty
- (B) It lacks territory, because borders agreed with a neighbour do not count as real borders
- (C) It has population, territory and a government, but lacks full sovereignty because an outside power can veto its laws
- (D) It lacks a government, because a vetoed parliament is not a real government

7. Over twenty years, Country Y is run first by Party A, then by Party B, then by a coalition, while its people, borders and self-rule never change. Which conclusion best fits?

(A) The government changed three times while the state - population, territory and sovereignty - persisted throughout

(B) The state was rebuilt three times while the government stayed identical throughout

(C) Both the state and the government dissolved and reformed at each handover

(D) Neither the state nor the government changed, since changing the ruling party changes nothing at all

8. A civics quiz asks: 'Who actually performs the work of making, enforcing and interpreting laws within a state?' Which answer is correct?

(A) The population directly, by personally drafting, policing and judging each law itself

(B) The territory, since laws cover the land and so the land does the work

(C) Sovereignty acting alone, with no organs involved at all

(D) The government, acting through its three organs - the legislature, the executive and the judiciary

9. A pamphlet declares, 'If our party is defeated at the next election, the nation's laws all expire and our country loses its independence overnight.' How many of these two claims are true?

(A) Both are true: a defeated party takes the laws and the country's independence with it

(B) Only the loss of laws is true; independence is lost but the laws continue

(C) Neither is true: existing laws stay in force until changed, and independence (sovereignty) belongs to the enduring state, not to any party

(D) Only the loss of independence is true; the laws expire but independence remains

10. A diagram shows a big oval labelled 'P' enclosing four shapes; one shape, labelled 'Q', is split into three slots reading 'makes', 'enforces', 'interprets'. What do P and Q stand for, respectively?

(A) P is the state (its four parts) and Q is the government (its three organs)

(B) P is the government and Q is the state nested inside it

(C) P is sovereignty and Q is the territory it contains

(D) P is the population and Q is the union tier within it

11. A debater says, 'Because a government can change every five years, the country itself is only five years old at most.' What is the precise flaw?

(A) There is no flaw: a country is exactly as old as its current government

(B) The flaw is that governments cannot change in only five years

(C) It confuses the changing government with the enduring state; the country (state) can be far older than any single government's term

(D) The flaw is that the state changes faster than the government, so the country is even younger

12. Which scenario best shows a state EXERCISING sovereignty (rather than merely democracy, territory or a breach of law)?

- (A) Citizens line up and cast their ballots on election day
- (B) Its parliament passes a tax that its own courts uphold, and no foreign power can overturn the tax
- (C) Surveyors paint the official boundary marker between it and a neighbour
- (D) A minister quietly breaks a rule he dislikes and is never questioned

13. Country M signs a trade treaty agreeing to common standards but keeps the final right to reject any standard; Country N must implement whatever a foreign capital orders. Which comparison of their sovereignty is correct?

- (A) M keeps full sovereignty because it retains the final say over its laws; N lacks full sovereignty because an outside power controls its laws
- (B) Both lack sovereignty, since signing any agreement at all destroys sovereignty
- (C) Both are fully sovereign, since making any agreement automatically proves sovereignty
- (D) N is sovereign and M is not, because M chose to align its standards with others

14. A student argues, 'Sovereignty just means having a big army, because the side with the most soldiers can enforce its will.' Why is this wrong in the chapter's sense?

- (A) It is correct: the state with the largest army automatically holds the most sovereignty
- (B) Sovereignty actually means having no army at all, so a peaceful state is the most sovereign
- (C) Sovereignty means a foreign power approves a state's laws, which armies help secure
- (D) Sovereignty is the recognised power to make and enforce one's OWN laws without outside control, not raw military strength

15. After an election, every soldier, police officer and senior clerk stays at their post; only the cabinet of ministers is new. A losing candidate complains this proves 'the election was meaningless.' What is the accurate reply?

- (A) The complaint is correct, because all soldiers, police and clerks should be sacked when a new party wins
- (B) Nothing changed at all, since the permanent staff and the ministers are one and the same thing
- (C) The government (the political executive of ministers) genuinely changed; the permanent state machinery - soldiers, police and clerks - rightly continues serving the state regardless of who wins
- (D) The unchanged soldiers and police are themselves the real new government

16. Which feature most sharply separates the BUREAUCRACY from the POLITICAL EXECUTIVE?

- (A) The bureaucracy is elected for a fixed term while ministers are chosen by competitive exams
- (B) The bureaucracy is non-elected, usually exam-selected, and stays on across elections; the political executive is made of elected ministers who change with elections
- (C) The bureaucracy makes the country's laws while ministers only enforce them
- (D) The bureaucracy changes completely at every election while ministers are permanent

17. A leaflet claims, 'Because the police carry weapons and can arrest people, the police chief is really the head of the government.' How does the chapter correct this?

- (A) The police are part of the state's machinery that the elected government directs; holding weapons or making arrests does not make them the government
- (B) It agrees: whoever holds the weapons is automatically the head of government
- (C) It says the police are part of the population with no role in running the state
- (D) It says the police are a foreign power placed over the state

18. A new minister tells a senior civil servant, 'You serve my party, so resign when we lose.' Why does this misunderstand the bureaucracy's role?

- (A) The civil servant should indeed resign, because the bureaucracy is replaced whenever a party loses
- (B) The civil servant outranks the minister and so cannot be given any instruction
- (C) The civil servant serves the state, not a party, and stays on across governments to give steady administration whichever party wins
- (D) The civil servant makes the laws and therefore answers to no minister at all

19. Three claims are made: (1) the army is one of the four parts of a state; (2) the army is the same as the government; (3) the army is state machinery the government directs. Which is correct, and what error do the other two share?

- (A) Claim 1 is correct; the army is the fourth part of a state alongside population, territory and sovereignty
- (B) Claim 2 is correct; whichever side commands the army is by definition the government
- (C) Claim 3 is correct; claims 1 and 2 both mistake state machinery for either a part of the state or the government itself
- (D) All three are correct, since the army is at once a part, the government and machinery

20. India is called a 'democratic republic.' A student asks precisely what each word contributes that the other does not. Which explanation is correct?

- (A) 'Democratic' means the people choose the government through free and fair elections (who rules); 'republic' means the head of state is elected, not a hereditary monarch
- (B) 'Democratic' means the head of state is hereditary, and 'republic' means citizens never vote
- (C) 'Democratic' refers to the size of the territory, and 'republic' refers to the size of the army
- (D) Both words mean the same thing, so the phrase merely repeats itself twice

21. Spain has a freely elected parliament that runs the country, but its head of state is a hereditary king. Using the chapter's framework, how is Spain best classified?

- (A) A democracy but not a republic
- (B) A republic but not a democracy
- (C) Both a democracy and a republic
- (D) Neither a democracy nor a republic

22. A country removes its hereditary monarch and now elects its head of state, but the law allows only one party to contest and voters cannot really choose. How should it be labelled?

- (A) A republic but not a true democracy
- (B) A democracy but not a republic
- (C) Both a full democracy and a republic
- (D) Neither a republic nor a country with an elected head

23. For a country whose head of state is a hereditary monarch, which combination of (democracy?, republic?) is IMPOSSIBLE under the chapter's framework?

- (A) Democracy = yes, since a country with a monarch can still elect its lawmakers
- (B) Democracy = no, since a country with a monarch might also lack free elections
- (C) Republic = no, which simply states the correct classification for a monarchy
- (D) Republic = yes, because a hereditary monarch is by definition not an elected head of state

24. A speaker says, 'India became a republic the moment it became a democracy, because the two always arrive together.' Why is this reasoning faulty?

- (A) Democracy and republic are separate ideas - a country can be a democracy without being a republic (like the UK with its monarch), so they need not arrive together
- (B) It is sound: every democracy is automatically a republic, so the two always coincide
- (C) It is faulty because a republic must come first and democracy only later
- (D) It is faulty because no democracy can ever also be a republic

25. Country G elects both its lawmakers and its president in free elections; Country H elects its lawmakers freely but keeps a hereditary monarch as head of state. Which pairing of labels is correct?

- (A) G is a republic but not a democracy; H is a democracy and a republic
- (B) G is a democracy and a republic; H is a democracy but not a republic

- (C) Both G and H are republics, since both hold free elections for lawmakers
- (D) Neither G nor H is a democracy, because having a head of state rules out democracy

26. A town's majority votes that a small religious minority may not open shops on a certain day, though everyone else may. A court overturns the vote. Which principle most precisely explains the outcome?

- (A) In a democracy the minority always rules over the majority, so the minority's wish prevailed
- (B) Majority votes are never valid for any decision, so this vote was void like all others
- (C) Only the majority holds rights, so the vote simply needed clearer wording to stand
- (D) Guaranteed fundamental rights and the rule of law shield minorities, so even a majority vote cannot trample protected rights

27. A leader argues, 'Since we won 60% of the vote, we may pass any law we like, including taking away a minority group's right to worship.' What is the strongest objection from this chapter?

- (A) There is no objection: a 60% majority may indeed pass absolutely any law
- (B) The objection is that only minorities, never majorities, may decide any law
- (C) The objection is that democracies have no laws limiting what anyone may do
- (D) The rule of law and guaranteed rights set limits no majority may cross, so even 60% cannot strip a minority's protected rights

28. How does protecting minority rights against the 'dominance of the majority' reveal the relationship between the rule of law and sheer numbers?

- (A) It shows that a large enough majority always overrides the law
- (B) It shows minorities are left with no protection in a democracy
- (C) It shows the rule of law stands above the bare wishes of the majority, since even a numerical majority must obey constitutional rights
- (D) It shows the Constitution can be freely set aside by whoever has more votes

29. A citizen says, 'If the rule of law really bound the government, then ministers and police would be punished for breaking the law just like ordinary people.' Is the citizen right?

- (A) Yes - the rule of law means no one is above the law, so the government, its ministers and the police are all bound by it like everyone else
- (B) No - the rule of law binds only ordinary citizens, never officials
- (C) No - the government writes its own exceptions and so stands above the law
- (D) No - the law applies only to minorities and the weak, not to powerful officials

30. An old saying calls a lawless society 'matsya nyaya,' the law of the fishes. A reformer concludes, 'That is exactly why we need a government bound by the rule of law.' Which reading is correct?

- (A) Matsya nyaya means everyone becomes equal on their own, so no government is needed
- (B) Matsya nyaya means fish literally make the best laws, which government replaces
- (C) Matsya nyaya means the strong devour the weak; a government under the rule of law exists precisely to prevent that
- (D) Matsya nyaya means the weak always overpower the strong, so the strong need protecting

31. Which situation is the clearest real-world picture of matsya nyaya actually taking hold?

- (A) A court convicts a wealthy company owner who broke the safety law
- (B) After courts and police collapse, armed gangs seize whatever they want and no one can be held to account
- (C) Voters peacefully replace a government they are unhappy with
- (D) An inspector fines a powerful factory for ignoring the rules

32. Why does the chapter present the rule of law as the OPPOSITE of matsya nyaya?

- (A) Because the rule of law lets the powerful ignore the law whenever it suits them
- (B) Because the rule of law applies only to weak and poor people
- (C) Because the rule of law works by abolishing the government entirely
- (D) Because the rule of law binds even the most powerful to the law, protecting the weak, whereas matsya nyaya lets the strong prey on the weak

33. Without any government or law, the chapter says society tends to slide toward a particular condition. Which condition, and what does this reveal about why government exists?

- (A) Toward matsya nyaya, where the strong prey on the weak - revealing that a government exists to maintain order and protect the weak
- (B) Toward perfect equality requiring no effort - revealing government is unnecessary
- (C) Toward a fully working Constitution appearing on its own - revealing law needs no enforcer
- (D) Toward the rule of law forming naturally - revealing the powerful will police themselves

34. A campaigner says, 'A strong leader who ignores the courts and silences critics is fine, as long as crime falls.' Which chapter idea best identifies the danger in this view?

- (A) There is no danger, because the rule of law means whatever a strong leader decides
- (B) The danger is only that crime might not actually fall, not that any principle is broken
- (C) The danger is that courts would then make the laws instead of the legislature
- (D) A leader above the courts and free of criticism breaches the rule of law, opening the door to the very domination matsya nyaya describes

35. An assembly of elected members spends weeks debating, amending and finally voting a draft pollution bill into law. Which classification of this work is correct, and why are the others wrong?

- (A) Legislative work - making law - because debating and passing bills is what a legislature does
- (B) Executive work, because the assembly is enforcing a pollution policy
- (C) Judicial work, because the assembly is interpreting the meaning of an existing law
- (D) Bureaucratic work, because civil servants are administering the session

36. The word 'legislature' traces to Latin roots for 'law' and 'a bringing or proposing,' while 'executive' traces to a root meaning 'to carry out.' Which organ does each etymology fit?

- (A) 'Legislature' fits the law-making organ, and 'executive' fits the law-enforcing organ
- (B) 'Legislature' fits the law-enforcing organ, and 'executive' fits the law-making organ
- (C) Both roots fit the judiciary, since judging involves both proposing and carrying out laws
- (D) 'Legislature' fits the judiciary and 'executive' fits the legislature

37. Order these three actions by organ: (i) members debate and vote a road-safety bill into law; (ii) officials issue instructions to put the new law into effect across districts; (iii) a court decides whether a driver actually broke that law. Which mapping is correct?

- (A) (i) executive, (ii) judiciary, (iii) legislature
- (B) (i) legislature, (ii) executive, (iii) judiciary
- (C) (i) judiciary, (ii) legislature, (iii) executive
- (D) (i) legislature, (ii) judiciary, (iii) executive

38. A citizen insists, 'The ministers we elect personally process every file and run every office each day.' Why is this misleading?

- (A) It is accurate: ministers do every administrative task themselves with no officials
- (B) The permanent executive - the non-elected, exam-selected bureaucracy - actually carries out day-to-day administration, whichever party wins
- (C) The courts, not officials, run the daily administration of government offices
- (D) The legislature personally manages every government office each day

39. Which contrast between the political executive and the permanent executive is correct?

- (A) The political executive is exam-selected and permanent; the permanent executive is elected and temporary
- (B) Both are elected for fixed terms and both turn over at every election
- (C) The political executive (ministers) sets direction and changes at elections; the permanent executive (bureaucracy) is exam-selected and stays on whichever party wins
- (D) Both are exam-selected civil servants who never set policy and never change

40. After a change of government, a senior civil servant keeps her post and faithfully implements the new ministers' lawful decisions. Why is this continuity valuable?

- (A) It lets the civil servant make new laws independently of the legislature
- (B) It means the civil servant has become the new political head of state
- (C) It proves the bureaucracy is completely replaced after each election
- (D) It gives steady, experienced administration so the state runs smoothly whichever party wins

41. A legislature passes a law that clearly violates a constitutional right. Acting as the 'watchdog,' what can the judiciary do, and what can it NOT do?

- (A) It can rewrite the law into a better version and pass it as the new law
- (B) It can examine the law and strike it down through judicial review, but it cannot itself rewrite and pass a replacement law
- (C) It can do nothing, since courts must accept whatever the legislature passes
- (D) It can order the legislature to hold a fresh general election at once

42. Why does an INDEPENDENT judiciary matter for the rule of law?

- (A) Because it lets the ruling party control the courts and approve its own laws
- (B) Because it makes the courts obey whatever the ministers wish
- (C) Only a judiciary free from the ruling party's control can fairly check even the government's own actions against the Constitution
- (D) Because it removes all checks on those who currently hold power

43. Match each organ to its defining verb. Which set is ENTIRELY correct?

- (A) Legislature - enforces; Executive - interprets; Judiciary - makes
- (B) Legislature - makes; Executive - enforces; Judiciary - interprets
- (C) Legislature - interprets; Executive - makes; Judiciary - enforces
- (D) Legislature - makes; Executive - interprets; Judiciary - enforces

44. Which action FALLS OUTSIDE the judiciary's power of judicial review as the chapter describes it?

- (A) Examining whether a law violates the Constitution
- (B) Writing and passing a brand-new tax law to replace one it has struck down
- (C) Striking down a government action that breaks the Constitution
- (D) Deciding whether a passed law is consistent with constitutional rights

45. Parliament passes a curfew law; police enforce it; a citizen then argues in court that it violates a constitutional right, and the court strikes it down. Which mapping of organs is correct?

- (A) The legislature made it, the executive (police) enforced it, and the judiciary used judicial review to strike it down
- (B) The judiciary made it, the legislature enforced it, and the executive struck it down

- (C) The executive made it, the judiciary enforced it, and the legislature struck it down
- (D) The police made it, the courts enforced it, and Parliament struck it down

46. A losing party complains, 'The courts struck down our flagship law even though we won the election, so the judges are anti-democratic.' Which response is most accurate?

- (A) The party is right: an elected government's laws must never be reviewed by any court
- (B) The party is right: judges may only review laws passed by parties that lost the election
- (C) The courts overstepped, because judicial review applies only to actions, never to laws
- (D) Striking down a law that breaches the Constitution is judicial review upholding the rule of law, not an attack on democracy - even an elected government is bound by the Constitution

47. A school principal during one term keeps students safe, runs the library and meals, and sets and enforces fair rules for clubs. If the principal models the government, these three correspond to which roles?

- (A) Protector, provider and regulator
- (B) Legislature, executive and judiciary
- (C) Union, state and local
- (D) Population, territory and sovereignty

48. Which single government action belongs to the PROVIDER role and to no other?

- (A) Deploying the navy to guard the coastline from attack
- (B) Building and staffing public hospitals across districts
- (C) Inspecting restaurants to enforce hygiene standards
- (D) Counting and announcing the results of a general election

49. A regulator (from Latin regula, 'rule') sets and enforces fair rules. Which PAIR of actions BOTH belong to the regulator role?

- (A) Sending soldiers to the border, and building a public hospital
- (B) Building roads, and counting votes in an election
- (C) Defending the coastline, and supplying free textbooks to schools
- (D) Inspecting factories for safety compliance, and fixing fair rules for trade in a market

50. Which single scenario shows the government playing ALL THREE roles - protector, provider and regulator - at once?

- (A) It only patrols the border and builds nothing and sets no rules
- (B) It only runs clinics and schools, with no defence and no rule-setting
- (C) It guards the border with the army, runs public clinics, and inspects shops for fair pricing rules
- (D) It only inspects shops and fixes market rules, with no defence and no services

51. A citizen files a Right to Information (RTI) request and learns how a road contract was awarded; a journalist then publishes the details and the public demands an inquiry. Which

idea best names what these two tools are doing TOGETHER?

- (A) Exercising judicial review, since RTI and the media strike down unconstitutional laws
- (B) Holding the government accountable through transparency - RTI revealing information and a free media spreading it so citizens can question the government
- (C) Performing the regulator role, since RTI and the media set rules for businesses
- (D) Exercising sovereignty, since RTI and the media make the country's own laws

52. A government is performing badly. Which list contains ONLY genuine, lawful ways for citizens to hold it accountable?

- (A) Refusing to vote, leaving every decision to one minister, and abolishing the Constitution
- (B) Appointing themselves as judges, dismissing the soldiers, and personally writing new laws
- (C) Ignoring elections, attacking the courts, and obeying the strongest local gang
- (D) Filing RTI requests, reporting through a free media, organising in civil society, and voting the government out at the next election

53. When citizens vote a poorly performing government out at the next election, which principle are they exercising?

- (A) Accountability - holding the government answerable for its performance
- (B) Sovereignty exercised over a foreign state
- (C) The government's own regulator role
- (D) Judicial review of the country's laws

54. A citizen whose pension was wrongly stopped uses an official complaints channel and gets it restored. Which idea best captures this, and how does it differ from judicial review?

- (A) Judicial review, since complaining about a service is the same as a court striking down a law
- (B) Sovereignty, since fixing a pension shows the state's power over its own laws
- (C) Grievance redressal - a form of accountability that lets citizens raise and fix problems with government services, unlike judicial review, which is a court's power to strike down laws
- (D) Decentralisation, since solving a local pension problem moves power to the local tier

55. India's government works at three TIERS. Which set names them correctly, and which common error do the wrong options share?

- (A) Legislature, executive and judiciary; these are the tiers of government
- (B) Protector, provider and regulator; these are the tiers of government
- (C) Union, state and local; the wrong options confuse the tiers with the organs, the roles, or the four parts of a state
- (D) Population, territory and sovereignty; these are the tiers of government

56. A neighbourhood drain is unblocked after the local municipal body decides on it, rather than waiting for the union government in the capital. This best illustrates which idea, and how does it relate to federalism?

- (A) Concentrating all power at the centre, which is what federalism means
- (B) Abolishing the local tier, since the municipal body replaced the union government
- (C) Handing control to a foreign power, which is what decentralisation means
- (D) Decentralisation - deciding a local matter at the local level - which works alongside federalism's sharing of power between the centre and state and local governments

57. Which arrangement best shows federalism AND decentralisation working together in India?

- (A) The union government in the capital personally decides every matter, from defence to a single village's drains
- (B) Power is shared among union, state and local governments, with local bodies deciding local matters
- (C) There is no central government, and each village governs itself fully independently
- (D) A single ruler in the capital approves every local decision before it can take effect

58. A teacher writes four phrases on the board - 'makes the laws', 'enforces the laws', 'interprets the laws and settles disputes', 'is elected by the people every five years' - and asks which one does NOT name a function of an organ of government. Which is the odd one out?

- (A) 'Makes the laws' - this is not a function of any organ of government
- (B) 'Is elected by the people every five years' - this describes how a government is chosen, not the law-related function of any one organ
- (C) 'Enforces the laws' - this is not a function of any organ of government
- (D) 'Interprets the laws and settles disputes' - this is not a function of any organ of government

59. A student writes three claims: (1) 'the government is the same as the state'; (2) 'in a democracy the majority can do anything it wants'; (3) 'every democracy is a republic.' How many are correct, and what is the best single correction?

- (A) All three are correct as written
- (B) Only the first is wrong; the other two are correct
- (C) Only the third is wrong; the first two are correct
- (D) Zero are correct: the government is only one of the state's four parts; rights and the rule of law shield minorities from the majority; and some democracies (like the UK) keep monarchs and so are not republics

60. Which statement weaves the chapter's ideas together CORRECTLY?

- (A) The government endures with four parts while the state changes at every election under the majority's unlimited will
- (B) The state and the government are identical, both governed solely by whatever the majority decides
- (C) The state endures with its four parts while the government - one part, working through three organs and three roles, across three tiers - changes at elections, all under the rule of law
- (D) The three tiers (union, state, local) are simply the same thing as the three organs (legislature, executive, judiciary)

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 18: The State, the Government, and You — Paper 4

Paper 4 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	C	21	A	31	B	41	B	51	B
2	B	12	B	22	A	32	D	42	C	52	D
3	D	13	A	23	D	33	A	43	B	53	A
4	B	14	D	24	A	34	D	44	B	54	C
5	D	15	C	25	B	35	A	45	A	55	C
6	C	16	B	26	D	36	A	46	D	56	D
7	A	17	A	27	D	37	B	47	A	57	B
8	D	18	C	28	C	38	B	48	B	58	B
9	C	19	C	29	A	39	C	49	D	59	D
10	A	20	A	30	C	40	D	50	C	60	C

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) The four parts of a state are population, territory, government and sovereignty. This community plainly has a settled population, fixed borders (territory) and the unoverruled power to make its own laws (sovereignty); what it lacks is a body actually running affairs, which is the government. Population is wrong because the people are already settled there. Territory is wrong because the borders are fixed. Sovereignty is wrong because no outside power overrules its law-making, which is exactly what sovereignty means.

2. (B) A state's four parts are population, territory, government and sovereignty; of the six listed, population, territory and sovereignty are three genuine parts (the missing fourth is the government as a whole). The judiciary is one ORGAN inside the government, the provider role is one of the government's three ROLES, and the union tier is one of the three TIERS - none of these is a part of the state. So the option naming the judiciary, provider role and union tier lists three non-parts; the two mixed options each smuggle in an organ, a role or a tier alongside genuine parts, so they are wrong.

3. (D) The analogy maps the enduring institution (the school) to the state, which is a political organisation of population, territory and sovereignty - not a set of buildings. Saying the building is the whole school repeats the very 'state = buildings' error the chapter rejects. Saying the teachers are the lasting institution reverses the analogy, since teachers (the government) are the changing part. Saying the school ends when teachers leave contradicts the analogy's whole point, that the institution endures while staff come and go.

4. (B) Sovereignty is the full power to make and enforce one's own laws without outside control; once X's people live entirely under a neighbour's laws with no power to make their own, sovereignty is gone and X is no longer a state - this is the decisive loss. A flag is a symbol, not one of the four parts (population, territory, government, sovereignty). An independent judiciary is an organ within the government, not itself a part of the state. A standing army is state machinery, not a defining part - a state can exist without one, so its absence does not end statehood.

5. (D) The state is the larger whole composed of population, territory, government and sovereignty; the government is only one of those four parts. Making the government the whole and the state a part inverts the true whole-part relation. Treating territory as the whole that contains the other parts mislabels one part as the whole - territory is land, one of four parts, not the container of all. Treating sovereignty as the whole likewise promotes one part above the state itself, which the chapter does not do.

6. (C) Population (citizens within the borders), territory (agreed borders) and government (an elected parliament and cabinet) are all present; the defect is that a neighbour can veto its laws, so it lacks full sovereignty - the power to make laws free of outside control. Electing a parliament does not by itself create sovereignty, so 'complete state' is wrong. Agreed borders are still real borders, so it does not lack territory. It does have a functioning parliament and cabinet, so it does not lack a government - the vetoes limit its sovereignty, not its possession of a government.

7. (A) Only the government (one of the state's four parts) changes when the ruling party changes; the people, borders and self-rule (population, territory, sovereignty) are the enduring state, which persisted. Saying the state was rebuilt while the government stayed identical reverses which part changes. Saying both dissolved each time ignores that the people, land and sovereignty continued unbroken. Saying nothing changed is wrong because the government genuinely did change three times.

8. (D) Making, enforcing and interpreting laws is the government's job, done through the legislature (makes), executive (enforces) and judiciary (interprets). The population votes and is governed but does not itself draft, police and judge every law. Territory is land, not an actor that performs tasks. Sovereignty is the backing power behind the laws, not an organ that drafts and judges - that work requires the government's organs.

9. (C) When a party loses, a new government simply forms; the body of laws continues in force until changed, and sovereignty (independence) belongs to the state, not to a party - so neither claim is true. Saying both are true ties the laws and sovereignty to one party's term, confusing the government with the whole state. The two partial options each keep one of these errors, wrongly attaching either the laws or sovereignty to the defeated party rather than to the enduring state.

10. (A) The big oval holding four shapes is the state (population, territory, government, sovereignty); the inner shape split into 'makes / enforces / interprets' is the government with its legislature, executive and judiciary. Labelling P the government and Q the state inverts the whole-part relation, since the state is the larger whole. Sovereignty and territory are single parts that do not split into three law-handling organs, so 'P sovereignty, Q territory' is wrong. The population and union tier likewise do not split into three law-handling organs, so the last option is wrong too.

11. (C) The government is one part of the state and changes at elections; the state - people, territory and sovereignty - endures across many governments, so the country can be far older than the current government. There is a real flaw, so 'no flaw' is wrong. Governments certainly can change in five years (that is the normal election cycle), so that is not the flaw. The state changes more SLOWLY than the government, not faster, so the last option reverses the relationship.

12. (B) Sovereignty is the power to make and enforce one's own laws free of outside control; a tax passed, upheld at home, and beyond any foreign power's reach is exactly that power in action. Voting expresses democracy (who rules), not sovereignty over law-making. Marking a boundary concerns territory, a different part of the state. A minister breaking a rule unpunished is a failure of the rule of law, not an exercise of sovereignty.

13. (A) Sovereignty is the unoverruled power to make and enforce one's own laws. M keeps the final say even while cooperating, so it remains sovereign; N must obey a foreign capital, so an outside power controls its laws and its sovereignty is incomplete. Voluntary cooperation where the state keeps the last word does not end sovereignty, so 'both lack it' is wrong. Merely signing an agreement does not by itself prove sovereignty, so 'both fully sovereign' is wrong. Being controlled from abroad (N) is the opposite of sovereignty, so saying N is sovereign and M is not reverses the truth.

14. (D) Sovereignty is a state's recognised authority to make and enforce its own laws free of outside control; it is a matter of lawful authority, not the size of an army. Equating it with military strength is the error, so 'correct' is wrong. Sovereignty does not require having no army; a peaceful state can be fully sovereign, so that option is wrong. Sovereignty means NO outside power controls or approves one's laws, so saying it means a foreign power approves the laws describes the opposite of sovereignty.

15. (C) Elections change the political executive (the ministers), while the permanent machinery - armed forces, police and civil servants - continues so the state runs smoothly; a real change occurred even though the permanent staff stayed. Sacking neutral staff for the winning party would politicise the state machinery and does not happen, so the complaint is wrong. The ministers and the permanent staff are different things, so 'one and the same' is false. Permanent staff continuing does not make them the government; they remain state machinery the government directs.

16. (B) The bureaucracy (permanent executive) is non-elected, exam-selected and continues across governments; the political executive is the elected ministers who set direction and change at elections - that is the sharp contrast. Saying the bureaucracy is elected and ministers are exam-selected swaps the two. Neither the bureaucracy nor the ministers makes laws - that is the legislature's job. Saying the bureaucracy changes at every election while ministers are permanent reverses which one actually turns over.

17. (A) The police are state machinery the elected government directs; they enforce laws but do not make or interpret them and are not the government, so holding weapons or making arrests does not make a police chief the head of government. Equating force with governing is the very misconception the chapter rejects, so 'it agrees' is wrong. The police do have a role (enforcement), so calling them mere population with no role is wrong. The police belong to the state, not a foreign power, so the last option is absurd.

18. (C) The permanent executive serves the state, not a party, and continues across governments to provide stable, experienced administration - so the demand to resign at a loss misunderstands the role. The bureaucracy is NOT replaced when a party loses; that continuity is its purpose, so 'should resign' is wrong. Civil servants implement the lawful decisions of ministers and can be lawfully instructed, so 'outranks the minister' is wrong. The bureaucracy enforces, it does not make laws (the legislature does), so 'makes the laws' is wrong.

19. (C) The army is state machinery that the elected government directs - claim 3 is correct. Claim 1 wrongly lists the army among the four parts (which are population, territory, government and sovereignty), and claim 2 wrongly equates the army with the government; both confuse machinery the government uses with either a part of the state or the government itself. So claim 1 is not correct, claim 2 is not correct, and 'all three correct' cannot hold because claims 1 and 2 contradict the correct claim 3.

20. (A) Democracy answers WHO rules - the people, via free elections; republic answers whether the HEAD OF STATE is elected rather than inheriting the post. The first option keeps these distinct and accurate. The second reverses both meanings. The third attaches them to territory and army, which are unrelated to these terms. The fourth wrongly treats them as identical, when each adds a different idea.

21. (A) Free elections for the lawmakers make Spain a democracy (the people rule); a hereditary king as head of state means it is not a republic, which requires an elected head of state - so it is a democracy but not a republic. 'Republic but not democracy' reverses the facts. 'Both' ignores the hereditary king that blocks republic status. 'Neither' ignores the free elections that clearly make it a democracy.

22. (A) Electing the head of state instead of inheriting it makes the country a republic; but with only one permitted party and no real choice, it lacks the free and fair elections that define democracy - so it is a republic but not a true democracy. 'Democracy but not republic' reverses this, since the head is now elected. 'Both' ignores the absence of genuine choice. It does have an elected head, so 'neither' and 'no elected head' are wrong.

23. (D) A republic requires an elected, non-hereditary head of state, so a country with a hereditary monarch can NEVER be a republic - 'republic = yes' is impossible. It CAN be a democracy if it elects its lawmakers (like the UK), so 'democracy = yes' is possible. It can also fail to be a democracy if elections are not free, so 'democracy = no' is possible. 'Republic = no' is simply the correct, possible classification for a monarchy, not an impossible case.

24. (A) Democracy (the people rule) and republic (the head of state is elected, not hereditary) are distinct; a country can be one without the other, as the UK is a democracy but not a republic, so they do not always arrive together. The claim that every democracy is automatically a republic is the error itself, so 'it is sound' is wrong. There is no rule that a republic must precede democracy, so that ordering claim is wrong. Many countries are both a democracy and a republic, so 'no democracy can be a republic' is also false.

25. (B) G holds free elections (democracy) and elects its head of state (republic), so it is both. H holds free elections (democracy) but keeps a hereditary monarch, so it is a democracy but not a republic. Saying G is a republic but not a democracy ignores its free elections that make it democratic. Free elections for lawmakers do not make a country a republic - that depends on the head of state - so 'both are republics' is wrong. Having a head of state does not rule out democracy, so 'neither is a democracy' is false.

26. (D) Constitutional rights and the rule of law protect minorities from the 'dominance of the majority,' which is why the court could strike the vote down - the majority cannot trample protected rights. The minority does not rule over the majority; rights protect it, they do not give it rule. Majority votes are valid for many ordinary decisions, just not for violating rights, so 'never valid' is wrong. The claim that only the majority has rights is the very misconception being corrected.

27. (D) The chapter stresses that constitutional rights and the rule of law bind even a large majority, so a 60% vote cannot strip protected rights - that is the strongest objection. Saying a 60% majority can pass anything endorses the very error. Saying only minorities may decide swings to the opposite extreme and is not what the chapter holds. Saying

democracies have no limiting laws contradicts the rule of law, which is precisely the limit at work here.

28. (C) Protecting minorities demonstrates that the rule of law - which binds everyone, including a majority - is stronger than the mere wishes of the numerically larger group. Saying a large majority always overrides the law inverts this. Saying minorities have no protection contradicts the guaranteed rights at work. Saying the Constitution can be set aside by more votes denies the rule of law that the example upholds.

29. (A) The rule of law holds that everyone, including the government, its ministers and the police, must follow the law - so the citizen is right that officials are bound just like ordinary people. Saying it binds only ordinary citizens contradicts the core idea. Saying the government writes its own exceptions places the government above the law, which the rule of law rejects. Saying the law applies only to minorities and the weak is the opposite of equal application under the rule of law.

30. (C) Matsya nyaya, the law of the fishes, describes a lawless world where the powerful prey on the weak; a government under the rule of law exists to keep order and prevent exactly that. It does not mean automatic equality - lawlessness produces domination, not equality. It is a metaphor, not a claim that fish legislate. And it is the STRONG who dominate the weak, not the reverse, so the last option misreads the saying.

31. (B) Matsya nyaya is the lawless state where the strong prey on the weak with no accountability - exactly what happens when courts and police collapse and gangs dominate. The other three are the OPPOSITE, showing the rule of law working to restrain the powerful: a court convicting a rich owner, citizens voting peacefully, and an inspector fining a strong factory all demonstrate accountability, not its absence.

32. (D) Matsya nyaya lets the strong dominate the weak; the rule of law is its opposite because it subjects everyone, including the powerful and the government, to the law and so shields the weak. Letting the powerful ignore the law would BE matsya nyaya, not its opposite. Applying the law only to the weak denies equal application. The rule of law needs a government to enforce it, so abolishing the government would undermine it, not define it.

33. (A) Lawlessness slides toward matsya nyaya, the domination of the weak by the strong, which is exactly why a government and the rule of law are needed to keep order and protect the weak. The other options imagine that equality, a Constitution, or the rule of law would appear by themselves with no enforcer, contradicting the chapter's point that order must be actively maintained by a government.

34. (D) The rule of law means everyone, including the leader, must follow the law and answer to independent courts; a leader who ignores courts and silences critics breaks this and risks the strong-over-weak domination of matsya nyaya. Saying there is no danger

redefines the rule of law as the leader's will, which is the opposite of the principle. The deeper problem is the breach of principle, not merely whether crime falls. Courts checking a leader does not make courts the law-makers; the legislature still makes laws, so the last option misstates the issue.

35. (A) Debating, amending and voting a bill into law is law-making, the legislature's defining function. It is not executive work, since no existing law is being carried out. It is not judicial work, since no dispute over an existing law is being decided. And it is not bureaucratic work, since elected representatives - not civil servants - are passing the bill, so administration is not what is happening here.

36. (A) 'Legislature' (law + proposing) matches the organ that makes laws; 'executive' (to carry out) matches the organ that enforces laws. Saying legislature fits enforcing and executive fits making swaps the two roots. Neither root describes the judiciary, whose task is to judge and interpret, so 'both fit the judiciary' is wrong. The last option misassigns both roots to the wrong organs.

37. (B) Passing a bill into law is the legislature's work; issuing instructions to carry it out is the executive's; deciding whether someone broke the law is the judiciary's - so the order is legislature, executive, judiciary. The other options scramble this mapping, for example placing enforcement or judging before law-making, or swapping the executive and judiciary, none of which matches what each organ actually does.

38. (B) The executive has two parts: ministers (political executive) set direction and change at elections, while the bureaucracy (permanent executive) actually runs daily administration across governments - so ministers do not personally process every file. Saying ministers do everything alone ignores the bureaucracy. Courts interpret law and do not run administration. The legislature makes laws and does not manage offices day to day, so those options are wrong.

39. (C) Ministers form the political executive - elected, direction-setting and changing with elections; civil servants form the permanent executive - exam-selected and continuing across governments for stable administration. The first distractor swaps the two. The second wrongly makes both elected and temporary, whereas the bureaucracy is permanent. The third wrongly makes both exam-selected and permanent, ignoring that ministers are elected and do set policy direction.

40. (D) The permanent executive stays on across governments precisely to provide stable, continuous administration regardless of who is in power - that is the value of the continuity. Civil servants implement, but do not make, laws (the legislature does), so the first distractor is wrong. Staying on does not make her the head of state. And her staying on shows the bureaucracy does NOT change completely after each election - the opposite of the last distractor.

41. (B) Judicial review lets the judiciary examine a law and strike it down for breaching the Constitution - the watchdog role - but writing and passing a replacement law is the legislature's job, not the court's. So the court cannot rewrite and pass a new law. It is not powerless against an unconstitutional law, so 'do nothing' is wrong. And ordering a fresh election is not within the judiciary's role of checking laws, so that option is wrong too.

42. (C) Independence lets the judiciary check even the government fairly, upholding the rule of law that everyone, including the government, must follow. The distractors all describe the OPPOSITE of independence - courts controlled by the ruling party, courts obeying ministers, or no checks at all - each of which would let those in power escape the law instead of being held to it.

43. (B) The legislature makes laws, the executive enforces them, and the judiciary interprets them and settles disputes - the only fully correct set. Each distractor misassigns at least one verb, for example making the legislature enforce, the executive interpret or make, or the judiciary make or enforce - none of which matches the organs' actual functions.

44. (B) Judicial review is the power to examine and strike down unconstitutional laws and actions - it does NOT include writing and passing new laws, which is the legislature's job, so that falls outside it. Examining whether a law violates the Constitution, striking down an unconstitutional government action, and checking a law against constitutional rights are all squarely within judicial review.

45. (A) Parliament passing the law is legislative; police enforcing it is executive; the court striking it down for breaching a right is judicial review by the judiciary - the first option maps these accurately. Each distractor scrambles the organs, for instance making the judiciary legislate, the police make laws, or Parliament strike down laws - none of which matches who actually performs each step.

46. (D) Judicial review lets independent courts strike down laws that violate the Constitution, upholding the rule of law that binds even an elected government - so it is not anti-democratic. Saying an elected government's laws may never be reviewed denies judicial review and the rule of law. Review does not depend on which party won; it depends on whether a law breaches the Constitution. And judicial review covers both laws and government actions, so 'only actions, never laws' is wrong.

47. (A) Keeping students safe is the protector role, running the library and meals is the provider role (supplying services), and setting and enforcing fair rules is the regulator role - the government's triple role. The distractors instead list the three organs, the three tiers, and the four parts of a state, none of which describes 'keeps safe / supplies services / sets and enforces rules.'

48. (B) Supplying services such as public hospitals is the provider role. Guarding the coast with the navy is the protector role (keeping people safe and defending the country). Inspecting restaurants to enforce hygiene standards is the regulator role (setting and enforcing rules). Counting election results is part of running elections, not any of the three roles - so only building and staffing hospitals is purely provision.

49. (D) Both inspecting factories for safety and fixing fair market rules are about setting and enforcing rules - the regulator role. The other pairs mix protector actions (border defence, coastline defence) with provider actions (building a hospital, building roads, supplying textbooks), and one even includes counting votes, which is election administration; none of those pairs is purely regulation.

50. (C) Guarding the border is protection, running clinics is provision, and inspecting shops for pricing rules is regulation - all three roles together. Each distractor shows only ONE role: defence only, services only, or rule-setting only - so none demonstrates all three the way the correct option does.

51. (B) RTI brings transparency by revealing the government's actions, and a free media spreads that information so citizens can question the government - together they hold the government accountable. Judicial review is the courts' power to strike down unconstitutional laws, which RTI and the media do not do. Setting business rules is the government's regulator role, not a citizen's accountability tool. And making laws is the legislature's job, not what RTI and the media do, so 'exercising sovereignty' is wrong.

52. (D) RTI, a free media, civil-society organising, and voting a poor government out are all genuine, lawful accountability tools. The other lists describe the OPPOSITE or the unlawful: refusing to vote, one-minister rule and scrapping the Constitution remove accountability; appointing oneself a judge, dismissing soldiers or writing laws personally are not lawful citizen powers; and ignoring elections, attacking courts and obeying a gang invite matsya nyaya rather than accountability.

53. (A) Removing a poor government by vote holds it answerable for its record, which is accountability. Sovereignty is the state's power over its OWN laws, not power over a foreign state. The regulator role is the GOVERNMENT setting rules, not citizens acting. And judicial review is a power of the COURTS, not of voters - so none of those names what the citizens are doing.

54. (C) Grievance redressal lets citizens complain about and resolve problems with government services, holding the administration accountable - distinct from judicial review, which is a court's power to strike down unconstitutional laws. Complaining about a service is not the same as a court striking down a law, so calling it judicial review is wrong. Sovereignty is the state's power over its own laws, not a citizen's service complaint. And decentralisation is about WHERE decisions are made (which tier), not about a citizen fixing a stopped pension.

55. (C) The three TIERS - levels at which government operates - are union, state and local. The wrong options mislabel the three ORGANS (legislature, executive, judiciary), the three ROLES (protector, provider, regulator), and three PARTS of a state (population, territory, sovereignty) as 'tiers,' a classic mix-up. Only union, state and local are the tiers.

56. (D) Letting a local body decide a local matter is decentralisation, and it fits federalism, which shares power between the centre and state and local governments. It is the OPPOSITE of concentrating power at the centre, so that option (and its false definition of federalism) is wrong. It relies on the local tier rather than abolishing it. And decentralisation has nothing to do with foreign control, so that definition is also false.

57. (B) Federalism shares power between the centre and state and local governments; decentralisation lets local matters be decided locally - the correct option shows both, with shared tiers and local bodies handling local matters. The distractors are non-federal or non-decentralised: total central control over everything, no centre at all, or one ruler approving every decision - none combines shared power with local decision-making.

58. (B) The three organs of government are defined by their law-related functions: the legislature makes laws, the executive enforces laws, and the judiciary interprets laws and settles disputes. 'Is elected by the people every five years' describes how a government is chosen, not the law-handling function of an organ, so it is the odd one out. 'Makes the laws' is exactly the legislature's function, 'enforces the laws' is the executive's, and 'interprets the laws and settles disputes' is the judiciary's - so each of those genuinely names an organ's function and is not the odd one out.

59. (D) All three claims are misconceptions. The government is just one of the state's four parts (population, territory, government, sovereignty). The majority cannot do anything it wants, because rights and the rule of law protect minorities. Not every democracy is a republic - the UK is a democracy with a hereditary monarch. So zero are correct, and only the full three-part correction fixes them; the other options leave one or more of these errors standing.

60. (C) The correct synthesis is that the enduring state has four parts; the government is one part, working through three organs and three roles and across three tiers, and it changes at elections, with everyone bound by the rule of law. The distractors embed familiar errors: swapping state and government and invoking unlimited majority rule; conflating state and government under the majority's will; and confusing the three tiers with the three organs - each contradicts the chapter.